

and independent. As we move to the next section, keep in mind that all by itself **f**³⁵ proves that a variant is early.

***f**³⁵ minority readings*

A look at my apparatus will show that I have designated as genuine nine readings with an attestation of 30% or less. In each case the deciding factor is the presence of **f**³⁵. I will now analyze these nine readings, beginning with the smallest percentage.

τη αγαθη εν Χριστω αναστροφη 3:16 [20%]

ECM lists only cursives 18 and 35 for the dative. To my disappointment, von Soden doesn't mention it, but Tischendorf does, citing his cursives 38 and 93 (Gregory 328 and 205), confirming that the dative is the reading of **f**³⁵. Tischendorf also cites his 137 (Gregory 614) for the dative, which has an 'independent' profile. So we know that the dative did not survive only in **f**³⁵. The dative is correct for the object of *επηρεαζω*, but copyists who were not familiar with this peculiarity would naturally 'correct' to the accusative. *ECM* lists 15 variations for the 6-word phrase. One of my presuppositions is that the NT books were inspired by the Holy Spirit, and I assume that He knew how to write correct Koine Greek.

During the last 150 years the 'harder reading' canon has been widely used to impute to John, Peter, etc. a variety of linguistic barbarities; after all, they were ignorant fishermen, Galilean rustics, or whatever. But let's stop and think for a minute. After Pentecost, as the Church exploded and it became obvious that the Apostles were going to have to travel widely, to have an 'international' ministry, would they not bone up on Greek (and even Latin)? If I were in Peter's shoes I would certainly have done so. In other words, I maintain that Peter and John and James were perfectly competent to write good or correct Greek.¹ To me it is significant that **f**³⁵ habitually sides with the grammatically correct reading, as it does in this case.

δοξαζεται Θεος 4:11 [20%]

Again, *ECM* lists only cursives 18 and 35 for this variant. To my disappointment, neither von Soden nor Tischendorf mention it. However, as illustrated by Tischendorf for the variant above, there will almost certainly be MSS not collated by *ECM* that side with **f**³⁵ here (unfortunately *TuT* doesn't include this set). The lack of the article emphasizes the inherent

¹ That there was a resident centurion in Capernaum, means that there were Roman soldiers stationed there. That Roman outpost was doubtless the most important customer in town for their fish. Their dealings with the soldiers would have been in Greek, presumably, so they had a beginning.